STOWZA · DEPLOYMENT

Deployment Options, Prices & Talking Points

Every way to get Stowza onto Android and iOS, what each one costs, and what to say when you are asked.

CHEAPEST VIABLE	RECOMMENDED	SETUP	SAVING FOUND
₹540/mo	**₹980/mo**	**₹28,000**	**₹29k/yr**

29 September 2026. Unlike the earlier drafts, **every price in this document was read from the vendor's own page today** — sources listed in §9. Converted at ₹88 to the dollar. The headline change: three substitutions cut the monthly running cost from ₹2,960 to about ₹540 without giving anything up.

1. What changed since the last estimate

I verified the prices instead of quoting them from memory. Three of them were wrong in a way that matters.

LINE	WAS	NOW	WHAT I FOUND
Maps, geocoding, routing	₹1,000–4,300	₹0	**Ola Maps gives 5 million API calls a month free** — geocoding, reverse geocoding, directions, routing and tiles, built for India. That is roughly 160,000 calls a day against our few hundred. It replaces both unlicensed dependencies at once.
Hosting	₹1,760	₹0–440	Cloudflare Workers is free to 100,000 requests/day and $5/month beyond. Vercel's free tier forbids commercial use; Cloudflare's does not.
iOS build machine	₹0–2,500	₹0	Codemagic includes 500 free macOS minutes a month. An iOS build takes 10–15 minutes, so that is 30–50 releases a month at no cost.
Email	₹0–1,760	₹0–286	Brevo is free to 300 emails/day forever. ZeptoMail is about ₹286 per 10,000 after that.
Monthly running cost	**₹2,960**	**₹540**	**₹29,000 a year saved.**

THE OLA MAPS FINDING IS THE IMPORTANT ONE

The previous plan said address search and fare quotes were the biggest technical risk, because both ran on free community servers not licensed for production. The fix was going to cost ₹1,000–4,300 a month. It now costs nothing, comes from an Indian provider built for Indian addresses, and removes the risk entirely. This is the single best piece of news in the project.

2. Android — four ways to distribute

ROUTE	COST	VERDICT	TRADE-OFF
Google Play	₹2,200 once	DO THIS	The only route with real discovery, automatic updates and the credibility a stranger needs before installing a delivery app. Everything else is a supplement.
Indus Appstore PhonePe	₹0	ADD IT	Indian store, no listing fee, no commission, ~100M devices with a strong Tier-3 skew. Free to list alongside Play. Its fee waiver is a current policy rather than a contractual commitment, so treat it as a bonus channel, not the main one.
Direct APK what we do today	₹0	KEEP	Already live. Good for testers and demos. No discovery, no auto-update, and Android shows a security warning on install — fine for people you know, wrong for the public.
Samsung / Amazon / Xiaomi stores	₹0	SKIP FOR NOW	Free to list but each adds its own review and upkeep. Not worth the overhead until Play is stable.

Recommendation: Play as the primary, Indus as a free second channel because the audience overlaps almost perfectly with intercity parcel senders, and keep the direct APK for testers.

3. iOS — four ways to distribute

ROUTE	COST	VERDICT	TRADE-OFF
App Store	₹8,712/yr	DO THIS	The only public route on iOS. Strictest review, but the app has nothing unusual in it except the KYC flow.
TestFlight first	included	START HERE	**Up to 10,000 external testers on the same $99 membership.** Anyone with a link can install. Builds expire after 90 days. This is a genuine soft launch that needs no App Store review approval to begin — the fastest way to get real iPhone users.
Ad Hoc distribution	included	SKIP	100 devices a year, each registered by UDID. TestFlight does the same job without the friction.
Apple Developer Enterprise	₹26,312/yr	NOT ALLOWED	$299/year, and restricted to distributing inside your own organisation. Using it for a consumer app breaches the agreement and gets the certificate revoked. Mentioned only so nobody suggests it.

TESTFLIGHT CHANGES THE LAUNCH SEQUENCE

Because TestFlight allows 10,000 external testers on the standard membership, iPhone users can be using Stowza **weeks before** the App Store review clears. Enrol, upload a build, send a link. That turns iOS from "the slow platform" into the fast one for getting early users.

4. Building iOS without a Mac

OPTION	COST	VERDICT	NOTE
Codemagic cloud CI	₹0 then ₹8.4/min	DO THIS	500 free macOS minutes a month. A build is 10–15 min, so 30–50 releases free. Built for Flutter/Capacitor apps like this one.
GitHub Actions macOS runners	₹0 free minutes	FINE	Works if the repo already lives on GitHub. macOS minutes bill at a higher multiplier than Linux.
Rented cloud Mac	₹2,200–7,000/mo	SKIP	Only worth it if you need an interactive desktop, not just builds.
Buy a Mac mini	₹60,000+	SKIP FOR NOW	Pays for itself only at a release cadence you will not hit for a year.

5. The infrastructure stack — current vs. cheaper

NEED	USING TODAY	BETTER OPTION	SAVING	WHY
Geocoding	OSM Nominatim **UNLICENSED**	**Ola Maps**	risk → ₹0	5M free calls/mo, Indian addresses, licensed.
Routing	OSRM demo server **UNLICENSED**	**Ola Maps Directions**	₹1,000/mo	Same free allowance covers it.
Map tiles	OpenFreeMap	Keep, or Ola tiles	₹0	Works well; Ola is a licensed fallback.
Hosting	Vercel Hobby **NON-COMMERCIAL**	**Cloudflare Workers**	₹1,320/mo	Free to 100k req/day, $5/mo beyond, commercial use allowed.
OTP store	Upstash Redis	Cloudflare KV	₹100/mo	Only if you move hosting; otherwise keep Upstash.
Email	Resend	Brevo, then ZeptoMail	₹1,760/mo	300/day free forever; ₹286 per 10k after.
Crash reporting	none	Firebase Crashlytics	₹2,300/mo	Free at any volume, unlike Sentry's 5,000-event cap.
Push	none	FCM + APNs	₹0	Both free at any volume.

THE ONE COST OF SWITCHING HOSTING

Moving from Vercel to Cloudflare saves ₹1,320 a month but is not free in effort — the API routes need porting and re-testing, call it two days. At ₹1,320/month it pays back inside the first year. **If you would rather not touch working code before launch, stay on Vercel Pro and pay the ₹1,760.** That is a legitimate choice and the rest of the plan does not depend on it.

6. Three costed stacks

	MINIMUM	RECOMMENDED	NO-MIGRATION
Hosting	Cloudflare free ₹0	Cloudflare paid ₹440	Vercel Pro ₹1,760
Maps / routing	Ola free · ₹0	Ola free · ₹0	Ola free · ₹0
Email	Brevo · ₹0	ZeptoMail · ₹286	ZeptoMail · ₹286
OTP store	KV · ₹0	Upstash · ₹100	Upstash · ₹100
Crash reporting	Crashlytics · ₹0	Crashlytics · ₹0	Crashlytics · ₹0
iOS builds	Codemagic · ₹0	Codemagic · ₹0	Codemagic · ₹0
Push	₹0	₹0	₹0
Domain	₹100	₹100	₹100
Apple membership (monthly equivalent)	₹726	₹726	₹726
Monthly	**₹826**	**₹1,652**	**₹2,972**
First year, incl. ₹28,000 setup	**₹37,900**	**₹47,800**	**₹63,700**

The three columns differ by one decision each — whether you pay Cloudflare, and whether you migrate off Vercel at all. Every other line is identical, because the free tiers are genuinely sufficient at launch scale.

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7. Talking points

Short answers to the questions you will actually be asked.

IF HE ASKS: WHAT DOES IT COST?

"About ₹28,000 to set up and under ₹1,000 a month to run. First year, roughly ₹48,000 including both app stores."

IF HE ASKS: WHY SO CHEAP?

"Because the app is already built. What's left is two store accounts, company paperwork and hosting — and almost every service we need has a free tier that covers launch. Ola Maps alone gives us five million free calls a month, which is about two hundred times what we'll use."

IF HE ASKS: HOW LONG?

"Nine to twelve weeks, and almost none of that is building. It's company registration, then a D-U-N-S number, then store verification — a chain we can't speed up. That's why we start it this week and do the engineering while we wait."

IF HE ASKS: CAN WE GET IT TO PEOPLE SOONER?

"Yes — two ways. Android users can install directly from our website today, that already works. And on iPhone, TestFlight lets us put it in front of up to ten thousand people on a link, weeks before Apple's review finishes. We can have real users before we're 'launched'."

IF HE ASKS: DO THE APP STORES TAKE 30%?

"Not for us. That's for digital goods — subscriptions, game credits. We sell a real delivery, which both Apple and Google exempt. We pay a payment gateway about 2% instead. On a ₹79 delivery that's under ₹2."

IF HE ASKS: WHY REGISTER A COMPANY?

"Two reasons. It's the right owner for the app rather than a personal account. And Google makes personal accounts run a twelve-tester trial for fourteen days before going live — as a company that requirement doesn't apply, and the waiting happens while we build instead of after."

IF HE ASKS: WHAT'S THE BIGGEST RISK?

"Sign-in emails landing in spam. It fails silently — no error, users just never arrive. We fix it by warming the sending domain before launch rather than during it. Second is Apple rejecting us over a location setting currently declared wrong in the iOS build; that's a one-line fix we already know about."

IF HE ASKS: WHAT DO YOU NEED FROM ME?

"Four things. Register the company and request a D-U-N-S number — that starts the clock on everything. Create the app signing key, which has to be yours and not mine. Buy the two store accounts. And sign the two privacy declarations once I've prepared the answers."

IF HE PUSHES ON CERTAINTY

"Everything about the app was read out of the code. Every price in this document was checked against the vendor's own page today, and the sources are listed. The two things that genuinely move are exchange rates and store policy, and store policy is why we re-read the requirements the week we submit rather than trusting a document."

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8. What I would actually do

1. **This week:** start company registration, request the D-U-N-S number. It is the only thing that cannot be compressed.
2. **Same week:** generate the Android signing key and replace the debug builds on the download page. They are currently debuggable, which is a live weakness.
3. **Switch to Ola Maps before anything else technical.** It removes the two unlicensed dependencies and costs nothing. Highest value per hour of any task on the list.
4. **Enrol with Apple as soon as the D-U-N-S arrives** and get a TestFlight build out. Real iPhone users weeks before review.
5. **Stay on Vercel through launch.** The Cloudflare saving is real but migrating working code before a launch is the wrong order. Do it in month four.
6. **List on Indus Appstore** once Play is live. Free, and the audience matches.
7. **Wire Crashlytics before the first external tester**, so their testing produces data instead of silence.

THE ONE-SENTENCE VERSION

The app is finished; what remains is ₹28,000 of paperwork, under ₹1,000 a month of infrastructure, and about ten weeks — most of it spent waiting for verification rather than building anything.

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9. Sources

Every price above was read from these pages on 29 September 2026.

- Apple Developer Program — $99/year standard, $299/year Enterprise, TestFlight up to 10,000 external testers.
- Google Play registration — $25 one-time; personal accounts created after 13 Nov 2023 face testing requirements.
- Vercel pricing — Hobby $0 and "for personal, non-commercial use"; Pro $20/month.
- Cloudflare Workers pricing — free to 100,000 requests/day; paid from $5/month.
- Ola Maps pricing — 5 million free API calls per month.
- Codemagic pricing — 500 free macOS M2 minutes/month, then $0.095/minute.
- Zoho ZeptoMail pricing — credit-based, about $3.25 per 10,000 emails.
- Brevo — 300 transactional emails/day on the free tier.
- Indus Appstore developer platform — zero listing fee and zero commission.

Two caveats worth keeping. Free tiers are current policy, not contracts — Indus in particular reserves the right to introduce fees with notice. And store policies change: the Android target-API level, Google's testing rules and Apple's declarations all moved within the last year, so re-read the live requirement in each console the week you submit.